

Friday, 18 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

20° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

19° 11°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

17° 12°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

15° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Human remains identified as mum missing since 2019.

A 56-year-old man is arrested after the remains of Joanne Sheen were found almost seven years after she went missing.

UK · NEWS

2 King Charles warns of 'existential danger' of AI falling into wrong hands.

The comments were made at a summit in Ayrshire with participants from AI giants including Nvidia, OpenAI and Anthropic.

UK · NEWS

3 UK needs 'credible path' on defence spending, says Nato chief.

Mark Rutte tells the BBC that UK ministers accept the need to make yearly steps to up spending.

UK · NEWS

4 Father's tribute to 'sweetest little boy' Noah.

Rhys Woods pays tribute to his three-year-old son and offers "deepest gratitude" to local people.

UK · NEWS

5 Ukrainian guilty of vandalism at mosques linked to Russian network behind Starmer arson attack.

Illia Bilyk, a 21-year-old Ukrainian man, has pleaded guilty to targeting five locations in east London.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 Stadium owner Robert Kraft says Ed Sheeran asked him to donate \$2m in aid after Macklemore backlash.
It comes after Macklemore pledged \$1m to Palestinian causes, challenging the tycoon to match the sum.
SHOWBIZ · UK

2 Palace in war of words with Earl Spencer over claims in Diana book.
The row threatens to overshadow a very crowded day for the royals - with the King and Princes William and Harry all attending events.
SHOWBIZ · UK

3 RTÉ to boycott Eurovision for second year in a row.
In a statement, RTÉ said it feels Ireland's participation "cannot be justified given the appalling and ongoing loss of lives in Gaza".
SHOWBIZ · UK

4 GTA 6 soundtrack reveal revives digital release debate.
Fred Again, PinkPantheress and Travis Scott provide new music for the blockbuster - but not all fans are happy.
SHOWBIZ · UK

5 How being music's Mr Nice Guy contributed to biggest crisis of Ed Sheeran's career.
Sheeran tries to stay away from politics and controversy, but that stance has come in for criticism.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 The big questions for Tuchel's first England squad since World Cup.**
Before Thomas Tuchel names his first squad since the World Cup on Friday, BBC Sport looks at the big questions facing the England boss.
SPORT · UK
- 2 River home to 500 crocodiles chosen as Olympic rowing venue.**
A river that is home to about 500 saltwater crocodiles is given the OK to host Olympic and Paralympic rowing and canoeing events at the 2032 Brisbane Games.
SPORT · UK
- 3 FA chair demands Infantino release World Cup sell-off documents.**
Fifa president Gianni Infantino has been told to release all documents relating to his controversial plan to sell off a stake in the World Cup.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Real Madrid keen on Man Utd forward Gabriel, 15.**
Real Madrid have a strong interest in signing 15-year-old Manchester United forward JJ Gabriel.
SPORT · UK
- 5 Hyrox athlete apologises for continuing race after soiling herself.**
Joanna Wietrzyk has also forfeited her win in the fitness competition after competing last week.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A heartwarming new trend sees neighbours sharing gardening tips through 'seed libraries' in local parks.**
These community-run stations allow keen gardeners to take and leave packets of seeds, fostering a lovely exchange of green-fingered wisdom and biodiversity.
- 2 The humble 'picnic blanket' is getting a stylish upgrade, with sales of designer versions soaring.**
No longer just a practical item, picnickers are now looking for blankets that are both comfortable and a fashion statement for their outdoor dining adventures.
- 3 A new study reveals that the delightful scent of 'freshly baked bread' is one of Britain's most cherished comforting smells.**
Researchers found that the aroma evokes strong feelings of home, warmth, and nostalgia for many across the country.
- 4 The unexpected hobby of 'identifying cloud formations' is gaining popularity among nature enthusiasts.**
Armed with guidebooks and apps, people are finding joy in recognising everything from fluffy cumulus to wispy cirrus, adding a new dimension to their walks.
- 5 Local cafes are reporting a charming rise in demand for 'vintage tea sets' to enhance the afternoon tea experience.**
Customers are loving the touch of elegance and nostalgia that a proper ceramic teacup and saucer brings to their cuppa.
- 6 A delightful trend sees families creating 'nature art' using found objects from parks and woodlands.**
From intricate leaf mosaics to twig sculptures, it's a wonderfully creative and free way to engage with the great outdoors.
- 7 The soothing sound of 'distant church bells' is being recognised as a surprising stress-reducer in a new survey.**
Many respondents noted the gentle chimes brought a sense of calm and a connection to local history and community.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: ...WE SNIFF THE BOX, DON'T WE? JUST A LITTLE WAFT TO SEE IF IT SMELLS PROMISING!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new television programme, especially if it's a big series launch. What is it?

ANSWER: ...WE MAKE SURE ALL THE CUSHIONS ARE PERFECTLY PLUMPED AND ALIGNED ON THE SOFA. ESSENTIAL FOR PRIME VIEWING COMFORT!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular piece of advice' about something seemingly small, like how to properly load a dishwasher or fold a towel, actually makes a huge difference in your daily life?

What's that one piece of surprisingly useful, everyday advice you've either been given or discovered yourself, that you now swear by?

- We all have that 'one particular type of sweet' or confectionary that, no matter how old we get, can still instantly transport us back to being a child and spark a happy memory, don't we?

What's your go-to nostalgic sweet treat that brings back all those wonderful childhood feelings? And what's the memory attached to it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** Did you know that the footprints left by astronauts on the Moon could remain visible for millions of years, as there's no wind or water to erode them?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that astronauts on the International Space Station regularly enjoy specially designed zero-gravity cricket matches during their downtime?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public park, Birkenhead Park in Merseyside, inspired New York's Central Park.
- A group of ferrets is called a 'business'.
- The distinctive smell of rain, especially after a dry spell, is called petrichor.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- Bubble wrap was originally invented in 1957 to be used as three-dimensional wallpaper.
- The national flower of England is the rose, while Scotland has the thistle, Wales the daffodil, and Northern Ireland the shamrock.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The earliest known example of knitting was found in Egypt and dates back to the 11th century.

On this day

Day 261 of the year, 104 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ariadne of Phrygia; Christian feast day: Constantius (Theban Legion); Christian feast day: Edward Bouverie Pusey (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Eustorgius I. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1935 — John Spencer, English snooker player and sportscaster (died 2006)
- 1949 — Kerry Livgren, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1962 — John Fashanu, English footballer
- 1971 — Jada Pinkett Smith, American actress
- 1973 — James Marsden, American actor
- 1984 — Dizze Rascal, British hip hop musician
- 1946 — Nicholas Clay, English actor (died 2000)
- 1961 — Mark Olson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1997 — The Anti-Personnel Mine Ban Convention is adopted.
- 1977 — Voyager I takes the first distant photograph of the Earth and the Moon together.
- 2009 — After 72 years on radio and television, CBS Television broadcasts the final episode of Guiding Light, the longest-running soap opera in American history.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1980 — Soyuz 38 carries two cosmonauts (including one Cuban) to the Salyut 6 space station.
- 2015 — Two security personnel, 17 worshippers in a mosque, and 13 militants are killed during a Tehrik-i-Taliban Pakistan attack on a Pakistan Air Force base on the outskirts of Peshawar.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2010 — Philippe Croizon becomes the first quadruple amputee to swim across the English Channel.
- 2018 — Cannabis is legalized in South Africa, through a ruling of the Constitutional Court.
- 1990 — Liechtenstein becomes a member of the United Nations.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 262 of the year, 103 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alonso de Orozco Mena; Christian feast day: Emilie de Rodat; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisca Cualladó Baixauli; Christian feast day: Goeric of Metz. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1963 — Jarvis Cocker, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1993 — Pi'erre Bourne, American record producer and rapper
- 1995 — Rachel Sennott, American actress
- 1963 — David Seaman, English footballer
- 1931 — Brook Benton, American pop/R&B/rock & roll singer-songwriter (died 1988)
- 1941 — Jim Fox, English pentathlete (died 2023)
- 1953 — Sarana VerLin, American singer-songwriter and violinist
- 1973 — Nick Colgan, Irish footballer and coach

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1976 — Turkish Airlines Flight 452 hits the Taurus Mountains, outskirt of Karatepe, Turkey, killing all 154 passengers and crew.
- 1991 — Ötzi the Iceman is discovered in the Alps on the border between Italy and Austria.
- 2022 — The state funeral of Queen Elizabeth II of the United Kingdom is held at Westminster Abbey, London.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1985 — Tipper Gore and other political wives form the Parents Music Resource Center as Frank Zappa, John Denver, and other musicians testify at U.S. Congressional hearings on obscenity in rock music.
- 2021 — The Cumbre Vieja volcano, on the island of La Palma in the Canary Islands, erupts. The eruption lasts for almost three months, ending on December 13.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar